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Search Committee
Data Analytics Program
Denison University
Granville, OH

Dear Members of the Search Committee,

I am writing to apply for the Visiting Assistant Professor position in the Data Analytics program at Denison University. I am a Ph.D. candidate in the Department of Economics at Johns Hopkins University (advisors: Christopher D. Carroll, Nicholas W. Papageorge, and Stelios Fourakis), and I expect to receive my degree in May 2026. My primary specializations are macroeconomic modeling, wealth and income dynamics, and computational economics.

My research agenda focuses on the ability of macroeconomic models to generate empirically realistic distributions of wealth and income over the life cycle. A key driver of that work is modeling heterogeneity in the rate of return on assets, and understanding how return dispersion contributes to portfolio accumulation across households.

In my job market paper, I calibrate a life cycle heterogeneous agent model to match wealth moments from the Survey of Consumer Finances by allowing households to differ in their portfolio returns. The model helps explain observed wealth concentration and return dispersion. In a related research project using the Health and Retirement Study, I examine how trust influences both income growth and asset returns. I find a hump shaped relationship for trust and returns (consistent with the literature) and characterize the distribution of the persistent component of returns to net worth. These experiences have equipped me to frame research strategies and design modeling approaches, execute econometric and simulation analysis with large micro data sets, and translate results into clear and rigorous written deliverables for both academic and practitioner audiences.

I am particularly drawn to Denison's interdisciplinary Data Analytics program and its emphasis on teaching students how to answer substantive questions with data. My work involves extensive data analysis using Python and Stata, including regression modeling, simulation methods, and large scale data management. I am comfortable teaching statistical reasoning, quantitative problem solving, and programming concepts using Python for data analysis. My background in empirical research allows me to emphasize not only how to implement statistical techniques, but how to interpret results carefully, assess model assumptions, and communicate findings clearly.

Denison's residential liberal arts setting is especially appealing. I value close faculty student interaction and the opportunity to mentor students as they develop both technical and analytical skills. I am enthusiastic about relocating to Granville and teaching in person within a collaborative academic community. The two year visiting term would provide an ideal opportunity to further develop my teaching while contributing meaningfully to the continued growth of the Data Analytics program.

I believe I would be a strong fit for this position because:

1. My quantitative and computational background aligns with the program's emphasis on statistical reasoning and programming.
2. I am committed to experiential teaching methods that integrate hands on data analysis with conceptual understanding.
3. I value the liberal arts tradition and am motivated to mentor students in an interdisciplinary academic setting.

Thank you very much for your consideration. I would welcome the opportunity to contribute to the Data Analytics program at Denison University.

Sincerely,

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